

ASHIKA RAMESH

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CAREER OBJECTIVE

Interdisciplinary designer with a record of turning nuanced research into systems-level insights. Experienced across HCI, service design, and visual communication, with a growing focus on how design thinking can address structural gaps in health access and digital equity. Comfortable working across complexity from ambiguous briefs to multi-method research and motivated by work that has meaningful downstream impact.

EDUCATION

RMIT University, Melbourne | Master's of Design Innovation and Technology
2022 - 2024 | Focus: Service Design, Systems Thinking, Design Research

National Institute of Fashion Technology, Chennai | Bachelor of Design
2017-2021 | Focus: Design Thinking, Pattern Making, Garment Construction

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant, HDR Admissions and Scholarships

RMIT University | April 2025 - Present

- Manage the initial HDR candidate admission process by maintaining meticulous application notes and ensuring all certified documentation meets institutional requirements
- Act as a primary contact for admissions and scholarships, managing fund source changes and investigating application statuses for candidates
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to maintain service quality standards while managing sensitive data across diverse user segments

Student Service Officer

RMIT University | February 2024- March 2025

- Served as primary touchpoint for **500+ student inquiries monthly**, identifying recurring friction points in university systems through pattern analysis
- Conducted informal user research through daily interactions, gathering insights that informed 3 policy recommendations for improved student experience
- Designed and documented improved guidance workflows for complex fee and loan processes, **reducing average resolution time from 72 to 48 hours**.

Design Intern

DDSN Interactive, Melbourne | August 2022 - December 2022

- Collaborated with marketing team to design visual content for multi-channel campaigns (email, social media, web, print)
- Iterated on design concepts based on campaign performance metrics and stakeholder feedback
- Maintained design consistency across touchpoints while working within brand guidelines and technical constraints

Graphic Designer

Cover It Up, Chennai | May 2021 - January 2022

- Designed A/B testing frameworks for **social media campaigns serving 80K+ followers**, using performance metrics to iterate design approaches and **improve engagement by 35%**
- Conducted competitive analysis and market research to inform design strategy for licensed product lines (NASA, Disney, Marvel)
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to maintain brand consistency across digital and print touchpoints.

CORE COMPETENCIES

*WHAT I LOVE TO DO

Qualitative & Quantitative Research, Presentation & Storytelling, Journey Mapping, Process Mapping, A/B Testing, Stakeholder Interviews, Service Blueprinting, Design Thinking Methodologies.

*WHAT I LOVE TO USE

Figma, Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Premiere Pro), Miro, Microsoft 365, Python and Database Management Systems.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Event Experience Designer

TEDx Chennai | October 2019 - January 2021

Designed end-to-end event experiences, collaborating with stakeholders to create engaging spatial layouts and attendee journeys.

Design Intern

HelpNow, Mumbai | September - October 2020

Developed logotypes and icons for digital and print applications

Footwear Design Intern

ZYF TEX PVT LTD | November - December 2020

Collaborated on product design development and market research for footwear product lines

RESEARCH

CHI 2026 - ACM CONFERENCE ON HUMAN FACTORS IN COMPUTING SYSTEMS 2026

"My Tummy Has a Little Dragon": From Everyday Experiences of Gut Sounds to Interoceptive Interaction Design

CERTIFICATIONS

- UI/UX Design Specialization - CalArts
- Introduction to Typography - CalArts
- Introduction to Psychology - Yale University
- Psychological First Aid - Johns Hopkins University

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent) • Tamil (Native) • Hindi (Fluent) • German (Basic)